

Frequently Asked Questions

What is REACH Partnerships Foundation?

REACH (Resources for Advancing Education and Careers in Health) is a pre-launch 501(c)(3) nonprofit that provides research fellowships to medical trainees preparing for NIH K-award applications. Each fellowship provides \$11,500 in grant funding administered through Emory University. We're unique because our funding model is self-sustaining—revenue from real estate referrals and sponsor partnerships grows with program success rather than depending on cyclical philanthropy.

Why focus on K-awards specifically?

NIH K-awards (K01, K08, K23) are the primary pathway to becoming an independent physician-scientist. They provide salary support and research funding during the critical transition from clinical training to research careers. However, 60-80% of applications are rejected, and trainees from less-resourced backgrounds face significant structural barriers. REACH addresses this gap.

How does the real estate referral model work?

Medical trainees relocate frequently—for residency, fellowship, and faculty positions. When REACH-affiliated trainees purchase homes through our Keller Williams network, the receiving agent pays a 25% referral fee (approximately \$3,000 per transaction) to REACH. This revenue directly funds additional fellowships. The trainee receives expert service; we receive sustainable funding.

What if fellows don't successfully obtain K-awards?

K-award success is our goal but not our only measure. Fellows who complete our program gain: (1) structured research experience and preliminary data, (2) a comprehensive K-award application framework, (3) mentorship connections, and (4) professional network expansion. Even without immediate K-award success, these benefits advance research careers. Many successful K-awardees submit 2-3 times before funding.

How is REACH different from existing fellowship programs?

Three key differences: (1) Sustainable revenue—our real estate and sponsor model generates income tied to program success, not donor fatigue. (2) Structured K-award preparation—our 12-question framework systematically addresses every NIH requirement. (3) Holistic support—weekly check-ins, relocation assistance, and sponsor connections address the whole trainee experience.

Why real estate? It seems unrelated to medical research.

Medical trainees are among the most mobile professionals in America. They relocate for medical school, residency, fellowship, and faculty positions—often 3-5 moves before career stabilization. This natural mobility creates an opportunity: by providing excellent relocation support (which trainees need anyway), we generate revenue that funds fellowships. It's a virtuous cycle that benefits everyone.

Who are the sponsors, and what do they get?

Sponsors are service providers who serve relocating professionals: real estate agents, financial advisors, attorneys, insurance agents, moving companies. For \$200/month, they gain marketing access to medical trainees—a high-earning-potential demographic. Sponsors receive curated content integration, not spam. Trainees benefit from vetted provider recommendations.

What's the relationship with Emory University?

REACH is piloting at Emory but operates independently. Emory trainees are our initial fellowship applicants, and we leverage Emory's research environment. As we grow, we'll expand to other Georgia institutions and beyond. We're exploring formal partnership structures with Emory's development and research offices.

How are fellows selected?

Applications are reviewed by a selection committee evaluating: (1) scientific merit of proposed research, (2) alignment with K-award trajectory, (3) applicant qualifications and commitment, (4) mentorship environment quality, and (5) contribution to workforce diversity. Fellows must have identified faculty mentors and demonstrate clear K-award intent.

When will REACH become a 501(c)(3)?

We plan to file for 501(c)(3) status following successful completion of our prototype phase in late 2026. Until then, we're exploring fiscal sponsorship arrangements to enable tax-deductible donations. Contact us for current giving options.

How can I get involved beyond financial support?

We're seeking: (1) Board members with expertise in academic medicine, nonprofit governance, or real estate, (2) Advisory committee members to guide program design, (3) Faculty mentors willing to support fellows, (4) Service providers interested in sponsor partnerships, and (5) Institutional partners at medical schools and health systems.

How will my donation be used?

Approximately 70-80% of every dollar goes directly to Emory for fellow support—tuition, research supplies, IRB fees, professional development, and grant administration. The remaining 20-30% covers REACH operations: platform development, legal/accounting, and lean administration. We publish detailed budget breakdowns and will provide annual impact reports to all donors. Full transparency is a core value.

More Questions?

reachpartnerships.org